



SCOTT OLSON Getty Images

A CUSTOMER shops last year for cookies manufactured by Mondelez International at a store in Chicago.

CITY’S LAWSUIT TARGETS SNACK GIANTS

San Francisco says 10 firms’ ultraprocessed foods are causing a public health crisis.

By KAREN GARCIA AND HANNAH FRY

In a historic action, San Francisco on Tuesday became the first government to file a lawsuit against food manufacturers over ultraprocessed snacks and drinks that officials argue are wreaking havoc on Americans’ health.

The lawsuit, which names 10 of the most popular food manufacturers known for highly processed fare — Kraft Heinz Co., Mondelez International, Post Holdings, Coca-Cola Co., PepsiCo, General Mills, Nestle USA, Kellogg, Mars Inc. and Conagra Brands — argues that the food industry knew its products were making people sick but continued to market the additive foods to maximize profits.

The suit doesn’t seek a ban on the sale of any products, but instead a statewide order prohibiting the companies from continuing what the city describes as “deceptive marketing” targeting children, particularly in Black and Latino communities. The city also is asking

[See **Foods**, A8]

Pregnant and shackled in ICE facilities

Women are held for months in dire conditions, advocates say. Some have miscarried.

By RACHEL URANGA

Lorena Pineda was five months pregnant when masked agents picked her up on a street corner near a San Fernando Home Depot in June.

An agent grabbed her from the vending stand she ran with her sister-in-law and put her against a car. “Be careful,” she told him. “I’m pregnant.”

“Don’t think I am going to let you go because of that,” she recalled him saying.

Immigration and Customs Enforcement policy states agents shouldn’t detain, arrest or hold pregnant, postpartum and nursing mothers for “administrative violation of immigration laws” barring “exceptional circumstances” or if their release is “prohibited by law.”

But pregnant women are increasingly picked up, deported and detained

under the Trump administration, advocates and lawyers contend.

Pineda, 27, was held at a downtown L.A. processing center before being transferred to San Bernardino, flown to Atlanta and then to a staging facility in Alexandria, La., and then taken on an hours-long ride to a rural part of that state — where for 3½ months she watched her belly grow and her dreams of life in America fade.

The American Civil Liberties Union has documented more than a dozen cases of what it says are pregnant women housed without proper medical care at Stewart Detention Center in Lumpkin, Ga., and the ICE processing center in Basile, La., where Pineda was held.

In one case, a woman was shackled while she miscarried. [See **ICE**, A8]



KARLA GACHET For The Times

LORENA PINEDA returned home to Van Nuys after months in custody.

‘Stranger Things’ back with a crash

Netflix’s hit series breaks viewership records and, briefly, the streamer itself.

By WENDY LEE

The final season of “Stranger Things” was so popular that Netflix on TVs crashed for a few minutes after the first four episodes dropped last Wednesday.

But that didn’t deter fans who generated 59.6 million views for Volume 1 of the final season last week, a record for the sci-fi series that began in 2016, according to Netflix. It also broke a record in viewership for the premiere week of any English-language show on Netflix.

“The sheer number of fans who have already watched Volume 1 is staggering — the response has been

more than we ever could have dreamed,” said the show’s creators, Matt and Ross Duffer, in a statement. “The show is now a decade old, and seeing the fanbase not only endure but continue to grow has been incredibly rewarding for us, the actors, and the thousands of artists who helped bring this story to life.”

The show’s throwback to the 1980s and its themes of friendship and adventure struck a chord with global audiences. It has become one of the most popular franchises for Netflix and helped propel the streamer’s business in live events and branding opportunities.

The next three episodes of the final season will be released Christmas Day, followed by the roughly two-hour finale Dec. 31.

The fandom behind “Stranger Things” is a force to be reckoned with. Netflix

[See **Netflix**, A11]

Trump tells Somalis: Leave

Comments come as ICE prepares operation in Minnesota targeting African immigrants. **NATION**, A5

Waste plan faces criticism

State OKs strategy for hazardous material disposal that opponents call “deregulatory.” **CALIFORNIA**, B1

Paramount ups bid for Warner

Stakes rise in auction for the studios with new Middle Eastern sovereign funding. **BUSINESS**, A9

Weather

Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 68/48. **B6**

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U.S. pardon for Honduran defies drug war narrative

Release of ex-leader, a convicted trafficker, raises questions about Trump’s campaign.

By KATE LINTHICUM AND MICHAEL WILNER

MEXICO CITY — Juan Orlando Hernández, a convicted drug trafficker who prosecutors said “paved a cocaine superhighway” to the United States, walked out of a West Virginia prison this week a free man.

That was thanks to President Trump, who on Monday granted a full pardon to Hernández, the former right-wing leader of Honduras who was serving a 45-year sentence for supporting what a U.S. attorney general had called “one of the largest and most violent drug trafficking conspiracies in the world.”

Trump’s extraordinary reprieve outraged many in Latin America and raised critical questions about his escalating military campaign in the region, which the president insists is aimed at combating the drug trade.

On Tuesday, Trump warned of imminent “strikes on land” in Venezuela, whose

leftist leader, Nicolás Maduro, has been described as a “narco-dictator” by the White House, which seems intent on forcing him from power.

“If Trump is supposedly a drug warrior, why did he pardon a convicted trafficker?” said Dana Frank, a professor emerita at UC Santa Cruz specializing in recent Honduran and Latin American history. She described the drug war narrative embraced by the White House as little more than a pretext to push U.S. economic and political interests in the region and justify “a hemispheric attack on governments that are not following what the United States wants.”

The U.S. has killed dozens of alleged low-level drug traffickers in missile attacks on boats in the Caribbean and Pacific and has massed 15,000 troops and a fleet of warships and fighter jets off the coast of Venezuela.

Venezuela, home to the world’s largest known oil reserves, has been controlled by Maduro’s leftist authoritarian government since 2013.

The White House has gone to great lengths this year to cast Maduro as a drug trafficking master—

[See **Pardon**, A4]

A twist in a SoCal housing battle

Planned apartments in Santa Barbara draw ire, then legislation in an unusual legal saga.

By DAKOTA SMITH AND JACK FLEMMING

Outraged Santa Barbara residents jumped into action when a developer unveiled plans last year for a towering apartment complex within sight of the historic Old Mission.

They complained to city officials, wrote letters and formed a nonprofit to try to block the project. Still, the developer’s plans went forward.

Then something unusual happened.

Four hundred miles away in Sacramento, state lawmakers quietly tucked language into an obscure budget bill requiring an environmental impact study of the proposed development — which housing advocates allege was an attempt to block the project.

The legislation, Senate

Bill 158, signed into law by Gov. Gavin Newsom, didn’t mention the Santa Barbara project by name. But the provision was so detailed and specific it couldn’t apply to any other development in the state.

The fallout was swift: The developer sued the state, and a Santa Barbara lawmaker, the powerful new president of the state Senate, is under scrutiny over her role in the bill.

The saga highlights the governor’s and state Legislature’s growing influence in local housing decisions, and the battle between cities and Sacramento to address California’s critical housing shortage.

In the face of California’s high cost of housing and rent, state leaders are increasingly passing new housing mandates that require cities and counties to accelerate the construction of new housing and ease the barriers impeding developers.

In this case, the law targeting the Santa Barbara development does the opposite

[See **Housing**, A7]

Getting off the mat after fire

Palisades inferno took a sensei’s dojo and home but didn’t change the way he shows up for his pupils

By HAILEY BRANSON-POTTS



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

CLASSES TAUGHT by the renowned Gerry Blanck have been a balm for students in this worst of years.

“Face! Center! Low! Hit him hard!”

The shouts — a husky voice with a Southern surf bo twang — echoed in the dojo as a 4-year-old with a headband reading “Lil’ Dragon” punched up at a scowling mannequin.

“Don’t jump. Just kick. ... Yeahhh!”

More shouts. A huge smile from the tiny boy, a karate student who says he’s almost 4 and a half, thank you very much. An even bigger smile from the shouter, sensei Gerry Blanck.

Nearly 11 months have passed since fire ripped through Pacific Palisades, and on this autumn Tuesday, Blanck was back doing what he’s done for 43 years: coaching toddlers, teens and grown-ups in the martial arts. For now, he is doing so in a temporary space in Santa Monica. His dojo on Marquee Avenue burned in the January firestorm. So did the homes of most of his students.

Like Eden Savoian, an 11-

[See **Karate**, A6]